DMC course: Week 1

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Homework

- Read the Course Syllabus
  - Check that you will have access to the three films in the Course Materials section.
- Read the Preface to the Course, which consists of sections:
  1. Genesis of the Course: Getting Perspective on Mind Control
  2. Shaping the Container
  3. What We Will Be Exploring
  4. An Arc of Stories and Lenses
     - You may delay reading the parts on the tales for weeks 2, 3, and 4, which will be repeated as part of the notes on the tale of the week.
- Read the Notes on *Notes from the Underground*.
  - This contains a section titled "Tale 1: Notes from the Underground", which exactly repeats the subsection by that name in section 4 of the preface.
- Watch "Notes from the Underground", one man show starring Larry Cedar, free on YouTube.

Questions

Here are some questions that may help guide your reflection. They are all about the protagonist in *Notes from the Underground*, who is not given a name in the story, but is conventially referred to as the Underground Man.

Concrete Questions about the Undeground Man

- What is his situation?
- How did he get into it?
- What was his dilemma?
- What about his personality might have cause him difficulty?

More Abstract/Subjective Questions in Preface Section on *Notes from the Underground* and Human Outlier Analysis

- How is the protagonist unusual in the society in which they live, and how are they trying to influence that society?
- Do you sympathize with the protagonist and his plight? What about the other characters?
- Can we usefully separate out the dysfunction from the creative insight?
- What does the protagonist see about society that those around him do not see?

Week1 Class Presentation

- links will be provide after class is held